

Vineet Kumar

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EMPLOYMENT	Purdue University, Mitch Daniels School of Business Professor of Marketing (“Dream Hire” Program)	2026 – Present
	Harvard University, Harvard Business School Visiting Scholar	2025 – 2026
	Yale University, School of Management Faculty Fellow, Yale Center for Customer Insights Associate Professor Assistant Professor	2020 – 2026 2014 – 2020
	Harvard University, Harvard Business School Assistant Professor	2010 – 2014
EDUCATION DEGREES	Carnegie Mellon University Doctor of Philosophy, Industrial Administration Master of Science, Industrial Administration Indian Institute of Technology, Madras Bachelor of Technology	
SUBSTANTIVE INTERESTS	Digital Economy, Platforms, Monetization Models	
METHODOLOGICAL INTERESTS	Structural Models & Causal Inference, Theory-based Machine Learning	
PUBLICATIONS	• Spatial Distribution of Access to Service: Theory and Evidence from Ridesharing. Soheil Ghili, Vineet Kumar and Fei Teng, Forthcoming at <i>Management Science</i> - Proceedings of the 21st ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (2020) • Nonparametric Pricing Bandits Leveraging Informational Externalities to Learn the Demand Curve. Ian Weaver, Vineet Kumar and Lalit Jain, <i>Marketing Science</i> (2025) 44(6) • Generative Interpretable Visual Design: Using Disentanglement for Visual Conjoint Analysis. Ankit Sisodia, Alex Burnap and Vineet Kumar, <i>Journal of Marketing Research</i> (2025) 62(3) - Finalist, American Statistics Association Section on <i>Statistics in Marketing</i> Award (2023) - Winner, INFORMS Society for Marketing Science Dissertation Award (2023) • A Theory-Based Explainable Deep Learning Architecture for Music Emotion. Hortense Fong, Vineet Kumar and K. Sudhir, <i>Marketing Science</i>. (2025) 44(1) - Winner, INFORMS ISMS Frank M. Bass Dissertation Paper Award (2026)	

- Winner, American Statistics Association Section on *Statistics in Marketing* Award (2022)
- Winner, Alden Clayton Dissertation Award, Marketing Science Institute (2022)
- Can Random Friends Seed More Buzz and Adoption? Leveraging the Friendship Paradox. Vineet Kumar and K. Sudhir, *Management Science*. (2025) 71(1)
- Demand Estimation for Subscriptions: Identifying Willingness to Pay without Price Variation. Cheng Chou and Vineet Kumar. *Marketing Science*. (2024) 43(4) 797–816
- On the Friendship Paradox and Inversity: A Network Property with Applications to Privacy-sensitive Network Interventions. Vineet Kumar, David Krackhardt and Scott Feld, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*. (2024), 121 (30) e2306412121
- Health Care Workers’ Reluctance to Take the Covid-19 Vaccine: A Consumer-Marketing Approach to Identifying and Overcoming Hesitancy. Brita Roy, Vineet Kumar and Arjun Venkatesh, *New England Journal of Medicine Catalyst*. (2020), 1 (6)
- Designing Pricing Strategy for Operational and Technological Change. Vineet Kumar and Yacheng Sun, *Management Science*. (2020), 66 (6) 2291-2799
- Estimating Dynamic Discrete Choice Models with Aggregate Data: Properties of the Inclusive Value Approximation. Tim Derdenger and Vineet Kumar. **Lead Article**, *Quantitative Marketing and Economics*. (2019), 17 (4), 359-384
- Linear Estimation of Aggregate Dynamic Discrete Demand for Durable Goods without the Curse of Dimensionality. Cheng Chou, Tim Derdenger and Vineet Kumar. *Marketing Science*. (2019), 38(5), 888-909
- Match Your Own Price? Self-Matching as a Multichannel Retailer’s Pricing Strategy. Pavel Kireyev, Vineet Kumar and Elie Ofek. *Marketing Science*. (2017), 36 (6), 908-930
- “Predicting Customer Value using Clumpiness” – Commentary. Vineet Kumar and Kannan Srinivasan. *Marketing Science*. (2015), 34 (2), 209-217
- Structural Models of Complementary Choices. Steve Berry, Ahmed Khwaja, Vineet Kumar, Andres Musalem, Ken Wilbur, Greg Allenby, Bharat Anand, Pradeep Chintagunta, Michael Hanemann, Przemek Jeziorski and Angelo Mele. *Marketing Letters*. (2014), 25 (1), 245–256
- Making “Freemium” Work. Vineet Kumar. *Harvard Business Review*. (2014), 92 (5), 27-29
- The Dynamic Effects of Bundling as a Product Strategy. Tim Derdenger and Vineet Kumar. **Lead Article**, *Marketing Science* (2013), 32 (6), 827-859
- Competitive Product Strategy for Open Source Software. Vineet Kumar, Brett Gordon and Kannan Srinivasan. *Marketing Science*. (2011), 30 (6), 1066-1078
- Structured Superpeers: Leveraging Heterogeneity to Provide Constant-time Lookup. Alper Mizrak, Yucheng Cheng, Vineet Kumar and Stefan Savage. *IEEE Workshop on Internet Applications*, 2003

WORKING PAPERS

- Designing Freemium: Strategic Balancing of Growth and Monetization. Clarence Lee, Vineet Kumar and Sunil Gupta, Major Revision at *Marketing Science*
 - Winner, INFORMS Society for Marketing Science Doctoral Dissertation Proposal Award
 - Winner, Alden Clayton Award, Marketing Science Institute
- Unveiling the Impact of Within-Content Engagement Information: Evidence from a Natural Experiment on YouTube. Keyan Zhu and Vineet Kumar, Major Revision at *Marketing Science*

- Pay Now or Wait to Unlock? Cliffhangers and Monetization of Serialized Media. Peter Lee, Vineet Kumar and K. Sudhir, Revise and Resubmit at *Journal of Marketing Research*
- Fairness for AUC via Feature Augmentation, with Hortense Fong, Anay Mehrotra and Nisheeth Vishnoi
 - Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency - FAccT (2022)
- Market Structure Mapping with Visual Characteristics. with Ankit Sisodia
 - MSI Working Paper (2025)
- Economic Analysis of Visual Design, with Ankit Sisodia

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- Designing Freemium and Free Trials for Digital Platforms: Insights from a Field Experiment. with Ian Weaver and Sreelata Jonnalagedda
- A Structural Model of Sequential Complementarity, with Peter Lee
- The Impact of Financing on Multisided Platforms: Evidence from the Digital Asset Market, with Vasundhara Sharma and Pranav Jindal
- Targeting Digital Ads based on Emotion, with Hortense Fong and Ravi Dhar
- Dynamics of Product Line Sequencing, with Tim Derdenger

INDUSTRY COLLABORATIONS (SELECTED)

- *IBM / American Express* (2015): Led a team of masters and PhD students in analyzing customer service representative interactions to directly impact revenue outcomes. Developed a predictive model to evaluate cross-selling and upselling effectiveness, incorporating call reason, representative actions, and timing. Identified key drivers of customer satisfaction for each call reason and recommended targeted process improvements, including agent training and recruitment strategies. Presented findings and recommendations directly to Customer Service Executives, influencing strategic decision-making.
- *HP* (2018): Spearheaded a semester-long project to optimize customer monetization and experience through comprehensive customer journey mapping. Uncovered non-linear and unexpected customer behavior patterns (e.g., cart use for comparison shopping), revealing key factors influencing customer journey completion and monetization. Provided actionable design recommendations to empower consumers in building consideration sets, reducing purchase uncertainty, and facilitating more effective decision-making. Presented findings to HP's CMO and analytics leadership at Palo Alto, CA, directly informing product strategy.
- *Verb* (2022-2023): Led a team of faculty, PhD students and research staff to design and evaluate a new product versioning strategy for a performing arts training content startup. Collaborated closely with the CEO, CTO, and academic team to develop an experimental design assessing freemium and free trial options. Experiment results demonstrated that permanent free versions yielded higher long-term monetization, and quantified the optimal amount of free content for sustained engagement. Presented findings to the company's executive team and product leadership, directly influencing product roadmap decisions.

CASES

- Mastercard: Marketing Transformation for a New World. Jean Rosenthal, Ravi Dhar, Vineet Kumar and Amy Wrzesniewski and Jaan Elias, Yale SOM Raw Case *18-013* (2018)
- The New York Times Paywall. Vineet Kumar, Bharat Anand, Sunil Gupta, and Felix Oberholzer-Gee (HBP Case *512-077*)
 - Case Center Award for “Best Case in Marketing” (2016)
 - Harvard Business Publishing *Most Popular*
 - Harvard Business Publishing *Premier Case Collection*
 - Translated into Portugese and Chinese
- The New York Times Paywall Teaching Note, with Sunil Gupta (HBP Teaching Note *512-099*)
- Healthymagination at GE Healthcare Systems. Vineet Kumar and V. Kasturi Rangan (HBP Case *512-039*)
 - Harvard Business Publishing *Most Popular*
- Healthymagination at GE Healthcare Systems, (HBP Teaching Note *512-105*)

ADADEMIC SERVICE

- Referee at *Marketing Science*, *Management Science*, *Journal of Marketing Research*, *Journal of Marketing*, *Operations Research*, *RAND Journal of Economics*, *Journal of Economics and Management Strategy*, *Information Systems Research*, *International Journal of Research in Marketing*, *Production and Operations Management*
- Senior Editor, *Production and Operations Management*, 2024-
- Associate Editor, *Management Science*, 2025-
- Informs Society for Marketing Science Dissertation Awards Committee, 2025
- Editorial Board, *Marketing Science*, 2014-2021
- Reviewer for MSI Dissertation Award (multiple years)
- Review Committee, Yale Customer Insights Conference, New Haven, CT (multiple years)
- Co-chair for Digital Marketing Track at *AMA’s Winter Marketing Educators’ Conference*, Orlando, FL (02/2014)
- Conference Advisory Committee, Interdisciplinary Conference on Marketing, Strategy, and Information Systems, Shanghai, China (08/2013)
- Co-chair for Invited Session on Complementary Choices at *Ninth Invitational Choice Symposium*, Erasmus School of Economics, Noordwijk, The Netherlands (06/2013)

AWARDS & HONORS

- Marketing Science Service Award (2021)
- MSI Young Scholar Award (2021)
- Management Science Meritorious Service Award (2018)
- Management Science Meritorious Service Award (2016)
- Case Center Award for Best Case in Marketing (2016)
- William W. Cooper Doctoral Dissertation Award, CMU
- Gérard Cornuéjols Fellowship, CMU
- Cylab Fellowship, CMU

- William Larimer Mellon Fellowship, CMU
- Certificate of Merit, Indian Institute of Technology

INVITED
PRESENTATIONS

- University of California, Berkeley, Spring 2026
- Purdue University, Fall 2025
- Harvard Business School, Fall 2025
- INFORMS Marketing Science Doctoral Consortium Faculty Fellow, Summer 2025
- University of Notre Dame, Spring 2025
- Boston College Distinguished Scholar Series, Spring 2025
- Northeastern University, Fall 2024
- Santa Clara University, Spring 2024
- Stanford University, Spring 2024
- Dartmouth College, Spring 2024
- AIM-AMA Sheth Foundation Doctoral Consortium, 2023
- University of Minnesota, Fall 2023
- Indian Institute of Management – Bangalore, Summer 2023
- Indian School of Business, Summer 2023
- University of Illinois at Urbana Champaign, Spring 2023
- University of Texas, Dallas, Spring 2023
- Yale School of Management Faculty Seminar, Spring 2023
- Carnegie Mellon University, Spring 2023
- University of Texas, Austin, Spring 2021
- Washington University at St. Louis, Spring 2020
- Yale University Quantitative Marketing Talk, Spring 2019
- Washington University at St. Louis, Fall 2019
- University of Chicago, Vithala R. Rao Celebratory Symposium, Fall 2019
- Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Spring 2019
- University of California, San Diego, Spring 2019
- University of Toronto, Spring 2019
- Yale Computational Social Science Seminar, Fall 2017
- University of Texas, Austin, IROM Seminar Series, Fall 2017
- Duke University, Spring 2017
- Columbia University, Spring 2017
- Emory University, Spring 2017
- Yale SOM Internal Faculty Seminar, Fall 2016
- Yale Institute of Network Science, Fall 2015
- INFORMS Marketing Science Doctoral Consortium Faculty Fellow, Summer 2015

- Yale SOM Faculty Seminar Series, Spring 2015
- Cornell University, Fall 2014
- University of Connecticut, Fall 2014
- Yale Center for Customer Insights Board, Fall 2014
- University of Chicago, Spring 2014
- Stanford University, Spring 2011
- Emory University, Fall 2009
- Georgia Institute of Technology, Fall 2009
- University of Rochester, Fall 2009
- McGill University, Fall 2009
- University of Southern California, Fall 2009
- Temple University, Fall 2009
- Ohio State University, Fall 2009
- Yale University, Fall 2009
- New York University, Fall 2009
- Columbia University, Fall 2009
- University of California, Berkeley, Fall 2009
- Harvard University, Fall 2009
- Northwestern University, Fall 2009
- Dartmouth College, Fall 2009
- Washington University, Fall 2009
- Texas A&M University, Fall 2009
- Purdue University, Fall 2009

INVITED
DISCUSSANT

- *UT Dallas FORMS Conference*, University to Texas, Dallas, Spring 2023
- *Virtual Quantitative Marketing Seminar*, Fall 2022 (panelist)
- *Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy*, University of California, Berkeley, Summer 2021
- *Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy*, University of California, Berkeley, Summer 2019
- *Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy*, University of California, Berkeley, Summer 2017
- *UT Dallas FORMS Conference*, University to Texas, Dallas, 03/2017
- *Quantitative Marketing and Economics*, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Fall 2015
- *Quantitative Marketing and Economics*, University of Southern California, Fall 2014
- *Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy*, University of California, Berkeley, Summer 2014
- *Yale China India Conference*, New York, Fall 2013
- *UT Dallas FORMS Conference*, University to Texas, Dallas, Spring 2013
- *Yale China India Conference*, Yale University, Fall 2012
- *Quantitative Marketing and Economics*, University of Rochester, Fall 2011

- *Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy*, University of California, Berkeley, Fall 2011
- *Marketing and Industrial Organization*, Yale University, Fall 2011

SELECTED
CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS

- Symposium on Artificial Intelligence in Marketing, University of Wisconsin, Spring 2026
- Marketing Science Conference (regular, almost every year)
- Northeast Marketing Conference, Fall 2023
- Marketing Dynamics Conference, Fall 2023
- Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy, Summer 2023
- Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Digital Analytics Conference – Invited Keynote, Fall 2022
- UT Dallas FORMS Conference, Fall 2019
- Marketing Dynamics Conference, Summer 2018
- Four School Conference (NYU, Wharton, Columbia and Yale), Spring 2017
- Business Analytics Meeting, Fall 2017
- Marketing and Industrial Organization Conference, Spring 2015
- Marketing Dynamics Conference, Summer 2016
- Business Analytics Conference, Miami, FL, Fall 2013
- Ninth Invitational Choice Symposium, Noordwijk, The Netherlands, Summer 2013
- Sunbelt – Social Networks Conference of the International Network for Social Network Analysis, Newport Beach, CA, Spring 2016
- International Symposium on Social Communication – Invited Plenary, University of Chile, Santiago, Chile, Summer 2012
- Eighth Invitational Choice Symposium, Key Largo, FL, Spring 2010

TEACHING

Yale School of Management, Yale University

- PhD: Seminar in Marketing (2015-current, taught by all faculty in quantitative marketing)
- MBA Elective: Artificial Intelligence: Strategy + Marketing (2022-)
- MBA Elective: Digital Strategy (2015-current)
 - Taught to MBA, Executive MBA and other Masters
- PhD: Empirical Models of Networks (2016)
- MBA Core: Customer (2015-2016)
- Executive Education:
 - Technology & Strategy, Executive MBA Students from Fudan University
 - BearingPoint Senior Managers Program
 - Yale Global Executive Leadership Program

Harvard Business School, Harvard University

- MBA: Marketing (Required Curriculum, Fall 2010 - Fall 2013)
- Executive Education:

- Marketing for Law Firms, Harvard Law School (2014, 2013)
- Strategic Marketing Management (2013)
- Business Marketing Strategies (2013)
- Digital and Social Strategies (2013)
- Taking Marketing Digital (2012)
- Doctoral: Marketing Models (Required Curriculum, Spring 2013)

Tepper School of Business, Carnegie Mellon University

- *Instructor:* Marketing I (Undergraduate Core, Summer 2009)

STUDENT
ADVISING

- Current: Keyan Zhu
- 2026: Peter Lee (PhD Candidate, Yale School of Management), Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: University of Texas, Dallas)
- 2023: Ankit Sisodia (PhD Candidate, Yale School of Management), Co-Chair of Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: Purdue University)
 - Winner, INFORMS Society for Marketing Science Doctoral Dissertation Proposal Award (2023)
 - Finalist, American Statistical Association Section on Statistics in Marketing Award (2023)
- 2023: Ian Weaver (PhD Candidate, Yale School of Management), Chair of Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: National University of Singapore)
- 2022: Hortense Fong (PhD Candidate, Yale School of Management), Co-Chair of Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: Columbia University)
 - Winner, American Statistical Association Section on Statistics in Marketing Award (2023)
 - Winner, Alden Clayton Dissertation Award, Marketing Science Institute (2022)
- 2021: Minkyu Shin (PhD Candidate, Yale School of Management), Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: City University of Hong Kong)
- 2018: Minkyung Kim (PhD Candidate, Yale School of Management), Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: University of North Carolina)
- 2017: Navid Mojir (PhD Candidate, Yale School of Management), Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: Harvard Business School)
- 2015: Samuel Shleifer (Yale Economics Undergraduate), Senior Essay Advisor
 - Winner, Ellington Prize for Best Senior Essay in Finance
- 2014: Clarence Lee (Doctoral Candidate, HBS), Co-Chair of Dissertation Committee (Initial Placement: Cornell University)
 - Winner, INFORMS Society for Marketing Science Doctoral Dissertation Proposal Award (2013)
 - Winner, Alden Clayton Award, Marketing Science Institute (2013)
- 2013: Pavel Kireyev (Doctoral Candidate, HBS), Field Exam Committee
- 2012: Lingling Zhang (Doctoral Candidate, HBS), Field Exam Committee

MEDIA MENTIONS	• Fortune, “Top analyst: 71% of SpaceX’s \$2 trillion value rests on AI. Grok’s numbers are ‘almost comical’ by comparison,” by Mia Osmonbekov, June 2026 • Wall Street Journal, “Social Media Platforms Are Asking Users for Money. They Probably Don’t Mean You,” by Laura Forman March 24, 2023 • Yale Insights, Three Questions: Prof. Vineet Kumar on Facebook’s Move into Cryptocurrency, June 2019 • NPR Marketplace, App sales plateau in the age of ‘freemium’, by Tim Fitzsimons, Feb 6, 2015 • Forbes, For ‘Freemium’ Companies, What Are Non-Paying Consumers’ Real Value, by Ava Seave, August 28, 2014 • Forbes, New Research Helps Find The Perfect Strategy For ‘Freemium’ Business Models, by Ava Seave, August 27, 2014 • Forbes, “Product Bundling is a Smart Strategy – But There’s a Catch”, by Dina Gerdeman , January 18, 2013 • International Business Times, “Something For Nothing: How The Videogame Industry Is Adapting To A ‘Freemium’ World” by Yannick LeJacq, September 15, 2012 • Wall Street Journal, “When Freemium Fails”, by Sarah Needleman and Angus Loten August 22, 2012 • Science Daily, “Benefits of the Open Source Software Market Identified”, Aug 16, 2011
INSTITUTIONAL SERVICE	• <i>School Area Committee</i>, Purdue University, 2026-current • <i>Faculty Recruiting Committee</i>, Yale University, 2014-2025 (several years) • <i>PhD Recruiting Committee</i>, Yale University, 2014-current (several years) • <i>Faculty Recruiting Committee</i>, Harvard University, 2010-2013 • <i>Doctoral Recruiting Committee</i>, Harvard University, 2010-2013
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	Member: American Marketing Association, INFORMS, American Economic Association
REFERENCES	Available upon request

Last Updated: June 2026